CHANGE-04 | Therapist only - all age groups

Memory, connection, and meaning by choice

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Offer the choice of whether and how to make room for a memory, connection, or something meaningful. The activity may be private, shared, or not happen; there is no obligation to remember in a particular way or find meaning in loss.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not request a reconstruction of a death or difficult event, interpret loss as good, or require forgiveness or farewell. A complex relationship may evoke mixed feelings. This activity is not exposure or trauma treatment; stop and adjust support if it becomes burdensome.

Reusing existing material

CHANGE-02 makes room for mixed feelings and CHANGE-03 for roles. Here, choose a limited form of expression according to the person's wishes; MEANING may fit only if the person asks to explore meaning.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Maya chooses to draw a game she played with her grandmother who died, and to keep the drawing herself. The adult accepts her choice not to display it and does not ask her to describe the day of the death.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

Do I want an activity involving memory or expression right now?

2 | Question for discussion

What would I like to make room for without requiring positive meaning?

3 | Question for discussion

What approach fits my preferences and cultural context?

4 | Question for discussion

What will the boundaries of sharing and participation be?

5 | Question for discussion

What will help me stop or choose an alternative?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If pressure arises to create a perfect memory or take part in a ritual, return to permission to do nothing too. Mixed feelings are not a reason to require a positive memory.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Creative activity is an option, not an obligation. When discussing death, use clear words appropriate to understanding, without comparing death to sleep or promising a return.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Agree in advance on privacy for a picture, writing, or online post. Do not pass creative work to family or a setting without appropriate agreement.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Make room for faith, custom, or not wanting a ritual according to the person's choice. Do not assume a beneficial relationship or an expectation of growth from loss.

OA | Older adults

A small memory can be chosen without summarizing a whole life. Helping produce a photograph or writing does not give a companion the right to choose its content or share it.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose a brief activity only when there is willingness and suitable support, with an option to stop. Collecting photographs, visiting a difficult place, or sharing publicly is not required by this sheet.

At the next session

Explore whether choice and privacy were preserved, not whether the activity improved mood. It is possible to finish without a product or a decision about continuing.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/feelings-symptoms-behaviours/feelings-and-symptoms/grief-bereavement-loss/
www.childbereavementuk.org/supporting-bereaved-children-and-young-people

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